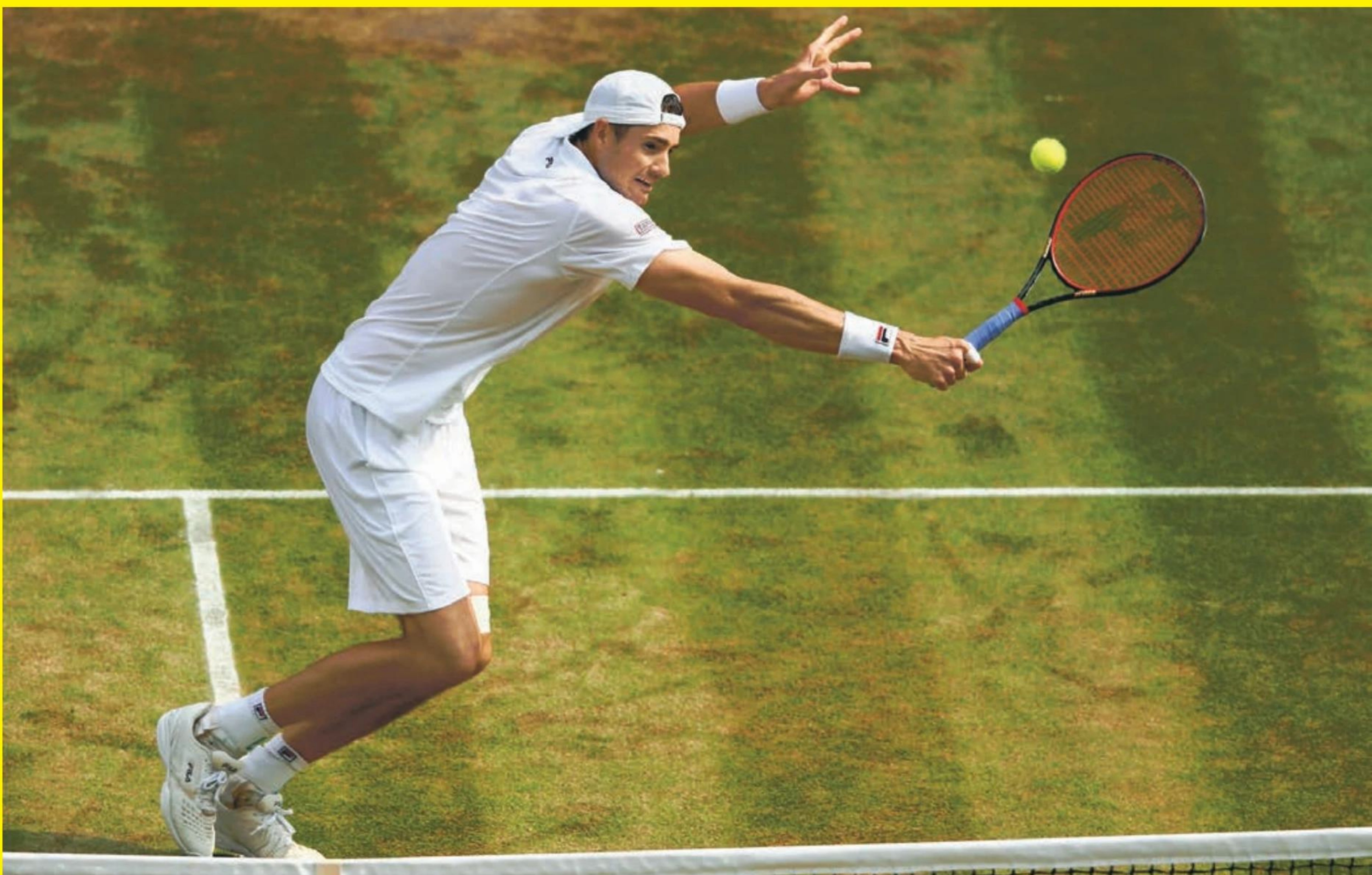




Net worth: A wide wingspan leads to a longer reach, which in turn helps during volleys and overheads, allowing a player to cover more area and put away shots more effectively. Players like 6'10" John Isner (in pic) used their reach well at the net.

manoeuvrability. They may struggle with rapid hand-eye coordination for short, fast exchanges. Specifically, compact strokes are harder to execute, particularly when returning fast, swerving body serves and volleying bullet-passing shots at the body.

In the 2000 book, **TABOO: Why Black Athletes Dominate Sports and Why We're Afraid to Talk About It**, Jon Entine wrote: "Since the first known study of differences between blacks and white athletes in 1928, the data have been remarkably consistent: in most sports, African-descended athletes have the capacity to do better with their raw skills than whites." Entine listed eight categories of "physical

and physiological differences known to date" that "Blacks with a West African ancestry generally have." The first category is: "relatively less subcutaneous fat on arms and legs and proportionately more lean body and muscle mass, broader shoulders, larger quadriceps, and bigger, more developed musculature in general." How much do you believe these genetic advantages relate to superior tennis performance?

Genetic advantages play a significant role, roughly 55%, in superior tennis performance, but they are just one piece of the puzzle. Tennis success is a combination of genetics, training, nutrition, mental toughness, and strategy.

Here are some key genetic factors:

1. Fast-Twitch Muscle Fibres — Elite tennis players often have a high proportion of fast-twitch muscle fibres, which enhance speed, explosive power, and agility — critical for quick reactions and acceleration on the court.

2. Aerobic and Anaerobic Capacity — A strong genetic predisposition for both aerobic endurance and anaerobic power helps players maintain high energy levels throughout long matches while also executing explosive movements.

3. Height, Limb Length, and Leverage — Height and limb proportions influence serve speed, reach, and court coverage. While taller players, such as 6'11" Ivo Karlović, have powerful serves, shorter players, such as 5'7" Diego Schwartzman, typically have superior agility and baseline movement.

4. Neuromuscular Efficiency — Superior coordination, reaction time, and proprioception are often influenced by genetics. This helps players react quickly to shots and execute complex stroke mechanics under pressure.

5. Injury Resistance — Some genetic markers influence tendon and ligament strength, reducing the risk of common tennis injuries such as ACL tears, stress fractures, and shoulder issues.